



Vacuum tubes still around!

Japan's Air Tight showcased these vacuum tubes at CES this year, for use in high-end amplifiers

Ford puts cars online

Plug in a phone to a USB port on the new Ford cars, and they become mobile hot spots

Trendspotting at CES 2010

We bring you the winning technologies and top trends of CES 2010

A farewell to keyboards

The Consumer Electronics Show (CES) 2010 was an even that finally saw many tech companies launching the Tablet PCs. It was finally good to see many manufacturers out with their version of the newest form factor. The icing on the cake being the presence of an Indian tech start up among the best names of tech world in that list. With laptops, netbooks and smartphones already offering most of the functionality expected in a tablet, it seems there is still a gap in the market somewhere. Many people want the portability of a cellphone, but with increased computing power. For many others tablet PC may just mean glorified e-reader or glorified touchscreen smartphone. So is 2010 going to be the year of the tablet PC? We will look at three of the tablet PCs that were launched at CES 2010 which created a lot of buzz.

The Adam has been developed by an India based startup called Notion Ink comprising six IITians and an MBA. On first glance it looks like a widescreen version of the iPod touch. It's based on the nVidia Tegra T20 chipset and supports 1080p Full HD video playback, has integrated Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and UMTS/HSDPA and an innovative Pixel Qi transflec-

tive display. It works on the Android UI. And the user gets all this for around US \$300 (Rs 15,000) Although most of the products were on the higher end of the price spectrum, Adam can be had under Rs. 15,000. So will this be a game changer in the tablet PC market. Lenovo's Ideapad UI touchscreen is a concept that turned around many heads at CES 2010 due to its unique form factor, which works even when detached. It is a hybrid in the sense that it works as a laptop and also as a standalone tablet when the 11.6 inch screen is separated. As a laptop it runs on a Core 2 Duo CULV processor with Windows 7 and has a 128 GB SSD drive. But when the display is detached, it becomes a stand-alone Linux tablet PC with a 1 GHz Snapdragon ARM processor having 16 GB flash memory. These features come at a hefty price of around US \$1,000.

ICD showcased the 15.6-inch Vega and a 7-inch Ultra. The Vega has a 1366 x 768 resistive touchscreen working on a 1 GHz nVidia Tegra T20 chipset like the Adam. It comes with a 32GB SSD and the connectivity options range from Wi-Fi, Bluetooth with optional 3G and HDMI, a device that is market ready.



Lenovo Ideapad UI, a netbook-tablet hybrid

For the Tablet form factor to be accepted, there are two schools of thought. We have convergence evangelists, for whom smartphone with internet capability is the ultimate device. But others feel that the limited screen size of a phone seriously hampers the whole user experience when dealing with media playback. So a Tablet is a device that tends to bridge that gap of portability and user experience. With Apple slated to announce its iSlate, it looks like 2010 is set to be the year of the tablets.

Netbooks get a performance boost

Netbooks are meant for basic computing tasks but with Intel announcing the Atom N450 Pine Trail platform for netbooks and nettops the performance bar has been

raised. With integrated graphics and memory controller on the processor, netbook users can expect a richer multimedia experience. Keeping this in mind we take a look at the interesting Netbooks launched at CES 2010.

Extremely low power consumption seemed to be the USP of many netbooks thanks to the Pine Trail platform. Toshiba Mini NB305 is loaded with an Intel Atom N450 1.66 GHz, 1GB of RAM, 250GB of HDD. It has a 10.1-inch TruBrite LED backlit display with 1024x600 pixel resolution. It promises an 11-hour battery life and has a 6 cell battery.

Samsung's N series of netbooks namely N210 and N220 offer battery lives of 12 hours whereas N150 and NB30 reach 8.5 hours and 11 hours respectively. They also offer support for 720p graphics. Each of them have a 10.1 inch screen and it features Easy Resolution Manager, which adjusts the screen resolution based